WEBINAR MODULE 2

Updating Your OKRs for the American System

Aligning Priorities with Sovereign American Capability

Joshua Konkle · Operator — configuration and execution

What You Will Leave With

- Clarity on the difference between goals and the OKR system that effectuates them
- A frame for redesigning OKRs around productive sovereignty
- Practical examples of rewritten Objectives and Key Results
- A simple exercise you can run with your leadership team

The Critical Distinction

OKRs are not the goals themselves.

They are a system for translating direction into coordinated execution.

When the system is aimed at the wrong outcomes, even strong effort produces misaligned results.

Most current OKR systems still optimize for short-term cost reduction, activity volume, or pure financial metrics — the same logic the financialization era rewarded.

The Productive Pragmatism Frame

Any system used to drive execution — including OKRs — must be re-oriented to these principles

01

Sovereign Productive Base

Build and control critical capabilities inside the United States

02

Merit & Capability

Develop real skill among American citizens with long-term stake

03

Directed Improvement

Capital and effort flow toward domestic capacity, not temporary labor extraction

04

People, Process, Place

High-capability American workers + advanced processes + domestic locations

Workforce Reality

Heavy reliance on temporary or short-cycle non-sovereign labor for core roles often undermines institutional knowledge, innovation culture, and creative problem-solving.

Diagnostic Questions for the OKR System

1. Which roles are truly critical to productive capacity over the next 3–5 years?
2. What percentage of those roles are filled by long-term American workers vs. temporary labor?
3. Are our current OKRs reinforcing long-term capability or simply managing short-term headcount?
4. Do our Key Results reward capability growth and innovation, or only cost and speed-to-fill?

Location & Domestic Capacity

The American System priority: strengthen domestic productive capacity whenever feasible.

1. Does this location choice increase or decrease long-term domestic capability?

2. How does it affect our ability to set and achieve meaningful goals around workforce quality and innovation?

3. Are we treating non-domestic options as temporary bridges toward greater American capacity, or as permanent low-cost substitutes?

OKR Redesign Principles

Objectives = directional goals · Key Results = measurable evidence of progress

OKRs as a whole = the operating system that translates strategy into coordinated execution

Objectives should explicitly strengthen domestic productive capacity, sovereign workforce development, and innovation-driven productivity

Key Results should measure capability growth, retention of high-skill American talent, expansion of domestic capacity, and genuine process or technology innovation

Avoid Key Results that only reward lower unit labor cost or maximum headcount flexibility

Practical Examples

BEFORE

Reduce production labor cost by 12%

AFTER

Increase the share of critical production roles filled by long-term American talent while improving output per labor hour through process innovation

BEFORE

Fill 100% of open technical roles within 45 days

AFTER

Build and graduate internal or partnership pipelines that supply critical technical roles with American workers within 12 months

Innovation Example – Robotics & Higher-Skill Work

Agricultural or industrial robotics that handle repetitive physical tasks can reduce dependence on low-skill temporary labor while creating higher-skill American roles in:

- → **Robotics engineering & systems integration**
- → **Maintenance and continuous improvement**
- → **Process control and optimization**

> The OKR system should reward measurable gains in productivity that expand high-capability domestic employment — not headcount reduction alone.

Exercise

Take one current company or departmental OKR.
Re-write the Objective and its Key Results so the system now drives productive sovereignty rather than labor arbitrage or short-term financial metrics.

Ask: Does this OKR strengthen domestic capability and high-skill American roles, or does it simply optimize for cheaper or more flexible labor?

Directing SI in OKRs

The human owns direction, decisions, standards, review, and final release. SI tools extend the work.

Human instruction: “Read the last quarter’s OKR check-ins and the current capacity metrics from these sources I am supplying. Return a one-page note that names which Objectives are still cost-only, which have a capacity Key Result, and one Objective that needs an owner rewrite. Do not recommend staffing changes.”

Bot’s bounded task: Collect and draft the one-page note from the named sources only. Stop at the draft. Do not post, do not change any file, do not invent a seat recommendation.

Review criteria: (1) Every claim has a named source. (2) Open items are listed, not solved. (3) No staffing or cost-cutting recommendations are added; relevant source facts remain accurately reported. (4) The note is one page.

Human release decision: Human reads the draft against the four criteria. If all four pass, human marks it ready and releases it. If any fail, human returns it with the failed criterion named. The bot does not self-release.

Name one Objective. Write the four-part split for one use of SI in reviewing its Key Results. Done when the four-part split is written.

Three Highest-Leverage Moves

1. Audit your current top-level OKRs and identify which ones still optimize for labor arbitrage or pure cost extraction.

2. Re-write at least one major OKR so the system explicitly rewards domestic capability, American workforce development, and innovation-driven productivity.

3. Align the redesigned OKRs with the Business Model Canvas updates covered in Module 1.

Next Steps

Canvas → OKRs → Operating Model → Value Streams → Workforce Strategy

If you would like support turning these ideas into a concrete 90-day plan or ongoing configuration and execution help, reach out directly.

Joshua Konkle

@7SwanSwimming · 512-423-5448 · joshua@digitalknowledge.net

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